

A STRUCTURAL CONJECTURE FOR THE INFINITUDE OF TWIN PRIMES

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ABSTRACT. We develop a structural reformulation of the Twin Prime Conjecture (TPC) in terms of additive closure properties of the set of twin prime witnesses. Every prime above 3 lies in one of two arithmetic channels; a *witness* w is a positive integer for which both $6w - 1$ and $6w + 1$ are prime. The central thesis is

$$\text{PNT} \implies (\text{WDC} \wedge \text{BC}) \implies \text{TPC}.$$

The right implication is proved: the Bridging Conjecture (BC) implies TPC unconditionally, and under the Witness Decomposition Conjecture (WDC), $\text{BC} \Leftrightarrow \text{TPC}$. The left implication — that PNT forces both additive closure properties of the witness set — is the central open conjecture.

The framework offers two independent paths forward, each sufficient for TPC. The first is purely structural: a direct proof of BC or WDC, requiring no analytic input. The second uses only the Prime Number Theorem: a proof that PNT implies channel exhaustion would close the argument via Euclid, without requiring the full structural conjectures. Together, these twin lines of evidence isolate the remaining obstruction with precision: either additive closure holds for arithmetic reasons, or PNT supplies enough prime density to force it analytically.

Key results are formalised in Lean 4 with zero `sorry`.

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PRELUDE: DUBNER'S BALL



FIGURE 1. The Dubner Ball at $|\mathcal{W}| = 20,000$ witnesses. Each point is a twin prime witness, coloured by residue class modulo 5 ($k = 0$: yellow/green; $k = 2$: blue/cyan; $k = 3$: red/orange). Witnesses with $k \in \{1, 4\}$ are absent by a theorem provable from $6 \equiv 1 \pmod{5}$ alone. Filaments connect each witness to its progenitor pairs — the pairs $(u, v) \in \mathcal{W} \times \mathcal{W}$ with $u + v = w$. The structure is not random.

This paper is a tribute to Harvey Dubner (1928–2019): electrical engineer, prime number hunter, and the sole inspiration for the programme of research it describes.

Dubner spent decades building custom hardware to search for large primes and prime constellations. Among his many contributions, he conjectured that the set $\mathcal{W}$ of twin prime witnesses — positive integers w such that $6w - 1$ and $6w + 1$ are both prime — is *additively self-generating*: that every witness $w > 1$ can be written as $u + v$ for some $u, v \in \mathcal{W}$. This conjecture, sometimes called the Middle Number Conjecture, is the load-bearing hypothesis of this paper. Dubner did not live to see its fate resolved. The present work is one attempt to

honour his intuition by developing the algebraic infrastructure that makes its consequences precise.

The object in Figure 1 — which we call the *Dubner Ball* [3] — is the directed graph whose nodes are the elements of $\mathcal{W}$ and whose edges connect each witness to its progenitor pairs. It lives naturally in three dimensions, organised by the three active residue classes of $\mathcal{W}$ modulo 5. The ball is not a heuristic: the absence of witnesses with $k \equiv 1, 4 \pmod{5}$ is a theorem, proved from $6 \equiv 1 \pmod{5}$ alone. The filament structure — the web of additive progenitors — is the visible signature of what Dubner conjectured.

The ball suggests something deeper. If witnesses are additively self-generating, and if the additive structure of $\mathcal{W}$ reaches across every threshold — bridging each frontier with a new witness built from old ones — then the infinitude of twin primes follows without ever directly asking whether a given large integer is prime. The logical landscape of this idea is developed in [4]. The present paper takes the next step: conjecturing that the Prime Number Theorem alone is sufficient to force the additive structure that the ball displays.

A NOTE ON THIS EDITION

Premature optimization is the root of all evil.

— Donald E. Knuth, *Computer Programming as an Art*
(1974)

This is the **literate edition**: the mathematics and the Lean 4 machine-verified proofs, presented together. The Lean 4 source files are in the `lean/` subdirectory of the repository.

The decision to present mathematics and machine-checked proof side by side was inspired by Donald Knuth’s vision of *literate programming* [5]: that a program — or a proof — should be written primarily for its human reader, with the machine as a secondary audience.

The **source edition** — which also includes the Interlude (§??) and the full literary voice of the document — is published alongside this edition at wildducktheories.github.io/twin-primes. The **academic edition** contains the mathematics only, with Lean 4 blocks and literary elements both suppressed.

1. INTRODUCTION

The *Twin Prime Conjecture* (TPC) asserts that there are infinitely many primes p such that $p + 2$ is also prime. Every such pair has the form $(6w - 1, 6w + 1)$ for a unique positive integer w , called a *twin prime*

witness. Let $\mathcal{W} \subset \mathbb{N}$ denote the set of all witnesses (OEIS A002822). TPC is equivalent to the assertion that $\mathcal{W}$ is infinite.

This paper develops a structural reformulation of TPC in which the remaining obstruction is isolated into a precise additive closure conjecture, rather than an analytic density estimate. The central thesis is:

$$\text{PNT} \implies (\text{WDC} \wedge \text{BC}) \implies \text{TPC}.$$

The right arrow is *essentially proved*: $\text{BC} \implies \text{TPC}$ is unconditional (Theorem 7.5), and under WDC, $\text{BC} \Leftrightarrow \text{TPC}$ (Theorem 7.6). The left arrow is the central open conjecture of this paper: that the Prime Number Theorem alone suffices to force both structural closure properties of witnesses.

The paper carefully separates unconditional algebraic identities from conjectural structural closure principles. No sieve-theoretic density estimates are used in the derivation of the structural implications themselves. This is the key methodological point: classical analytic approaches (sieve theory, GPY/Maynard) work directly on primes and encounter the parity obstruction. The structural approach inverts this. Rather than detecting primality via sieve cancellation, it asks whether the *additive closure* of $\mathcal{W}$ is sufficient to guarantee its infinitude. The framework avoids direct engagement with the parity obstruction because it does not attempt to detect primality via sieve cancellation.

Line 1 — Additive structure (purely algebraic, no analytic input): the Witness Decomposition Conjecture (WDC) and the Bridging Conjecture (BC) assert additive closure properties of $\mathcal{W}$ at global and threshold scales respectively. Their proved implications yield $\text{BC} \implies \text{TPC}$ unconditionally.

Line 2 — Channel exhaustion (bridge to the analytic world): a diagnostic tool showing precisely where the structural approach hands off to analysis. Channel exhaustion sits nearer to classical analytic questions than WDC or BC, but connects the additive structure of $\mathcal{W}$ to the broader distribution of primes via the channel representation.

The Gap Conjecture (GC) — that consecutive witnesses satisfy $w_{n+1} \leq 2w_n$ — is a metric consequence of the structural conjectures, not a foundational assumption. Both WDC and BC independently imply GC (Section 6); GC implies neither. It is named and stated for reference but is not a load-bearing conjecture in the argument.

The paper is organised as follows. Section 2 introduces the two-channel representation and the defect forms. Section 3 states and

proves the Multiplexing Identity. Section 4 establishes algebraic constraints on witnesses via forbidden residues and arithmetic progression bounds. Section 6 presents GC as a metric corollary. Section 7 develops Line 1: the additive structure of witnesses, WDC, BC, and their proved implications. Section 11 develops Line 2: channel exhaustion as the analytic bridge. Section 12 states the Structural Conjecture and explains what it would mean if true. Section 13 concludes. The appendix provides a logical dependency map of all results.

Part 1. Foundations

2. THE CHANNEL REPRESENTATION

Definition 2.1. For $m \geq 1$, define the *lower channel value* $L_m := 6m - 1$ and the *upper channel value* $H_m := 6m + 1$.

Remark 2.2 (Why channels?). The integers $\equiv -1 \pmod{6}$ and $\equiv +1 \pmod{6}$ form two parallel arithmetic progressions — two infinite *channels* through which all primes above 3 must flow. The index m parameterises both channels simultaneously: L_m and H_m are the unique elements at position m in the lower and upper channel respectively, and they always differ by exactly 2. A twin prime pair is precisely a position m at which both channels simultaneously carry a prime.

The term *multiplexing* follows naturally: adding two witnesses u and v combines their channel signals into a single new index $u + v$, with the Multiplexing Identity (Section 3) describing exactly how the channel values combine.

```
def lowerChannel (m : N) : N := 6 * m - 1
def upperChannel (m : N) : N := 6 * m + 1
def IsWitness (m : N) : Prop :=
  1 <= m /\ (6 * m - 1 : N).Prime /\ (6 * m + 1
    : N).Prime
def baseWitness : N := 1 -- L_1 = 5, H_1 = 7
theorem baseWitness_isWitness : IsWitness
  baseWitness := by decide
```

Every prime $p > 3$ satisfies $p \equiv \pm 1 \pmod{6}$, so every prime $p > 3$ is either a lower channel value L_m or an upper channel value H_m for a unique $m \geq 1$. The channels are *universal for primes*: they cover every prime above 3.

Lemma 2.3 (Primes in channels). *Every prime $p > 3$ lies in a channel: there exists $m \geq 1$ such that $p = L_m$ or $p = H_m$.*

Proof. Since $p > 3$ is prime, $\gcd(p, 6) = 1$, so $p \equiv 1$ or $p \equiv 5 \pmod{6}$.
 If $p \equiv 1 \pmod{6}$: set $m = (p - 1)/6 \geq 1$; then $H_m = 6m + 1 = p$. If
 $p \equiv 5 \pmod{6}$: set $m = (p + 1)/6 \geq 1$; then $L_m = 6m - 1 = p$. $\square$

Remark 2.4. Lemma 2.3 is formally verified in Lean 4 (`prime_in_channel`, zero sorry).

```

theorem prime_in_channel {p : N} (hp : p.Prime)
  (hp3 : 3 < p) :
  exists m, 1 <= m /\ (p = lowerChannel m /\ p
    = upperChannel m) := by
  have h : p % 6 = 1 /\ p % 6 = 5 := by ... --
    from primality
  cases h with
  | inl h => exact <p / 6, by omega, Or.inr (by
    unfold upperChannel; omega)>
  | inr h => exact <p / 6 + 1, by omega, Or.inl
    (by unfold lowerChannel; omega)>

```

Twin prime pairs $(p, p+2)$ with $p > 3$ are precisely the pairs (L_m, H_m) for some $m \geq 1$: the two channels satisfy $H_m - L_m = 2$ for all m . The channels are universal, but witnesses isolate those channel indices m supporting *simultaneous* primality in both channels.

Definition 2.5. A positive integer m is a *witness* if L_m and H_m are both prime. Let $\mathcal{W}$ denote the set of all witnesses. The base witness is $\omega := 1$ ($L_1 = 5$, $H_1 = 7$). A positive integer $m \notin \mathcal{W}$ is a *defect*; let $\mathcal{D} := \mathbb{N}_{>0} \setminus \mathcal{W}$.

Remark 2.6. The Twin Prime Conjecture is equivalent to the assertion that $\mathcal{W}$ is infinite.

2.1. The defect forms. Since every prime factor of L_m or H_m is itself $\equiv \pm 1 \pmod{6}$, composite channel values factorise in a constrained way. The mod-6 product table,

$$(6a-1)(6b-1) \equiv +1, \quad (6a+1)(6b+1) \equiv +1, \quad (6a-1)(6b+1) \equiv -1 \pmod{6},$$

yields the following complete characterisation of defects.

Proposition 2.7 (Defect forms). *Let $m \geq 1$.*

- (1) *If L_m is composite, then $m = 6ab + a - b$ for some $a, b \geq 1$. (Type $\dashv$)*
- (2) *If H_m is composite with both prime factors $\equiv -1 \pmod{6}$, then $m = 6ab - a - b$ for some $a, b \geq 1$. (Type $\dashv$)*
- (3) *If H_m is composite with both prime factors $\equiv +1 \pmod{6}$, then $m = 6ab + a + b$ for some $a, b \geq 1$. (Type $++$)*

Consequently, m is a witness if and only if it belongs to none of these three forms for any $a, b \geq 1$.

Proof. Type $\dashv$: $(6a - 1)(6b + 1) = 36ab + 6a - 6b - 1$, so $6m - 1 = 36ab + 6a - 6b - 1$ gives $m = 6ab + a - b$. The remaining types follow by expanding $(6a - 1)(6b - 1)$ and $(6a + 1)(6b + 1)$. $\square$

Remark 2.8. Proposition 2.7 was independently discovered by Balestrieri [2], who states it as Lemma 2.1 and uses it to reformulate TPC as: *there exist infinitely many n simultaneously avoiding all three defect forms*. The present paper develops this characterisation further via the Multiplexing Identity (Theorem 3.1).

Non-witnesses are not random: they fall into exactly three algebraic families. This is the first structural result of the paper and the foundation on which the Multiplexing Identity, the additive conjectures, and the channel exhaustion argument all rest.

3. THE MULTIPLEXING IDENTITY

The Multiplexing Identity is the central algebraic mechanism of the paper. It expresses the channel values of a sum $w = u + v$ directly in terms of those of u and v , enabling every later result to be stated in terms of additive structure on $\mathcal{W}$.

Theorem 3.1 (Multiplexing Identity). *For all $u, v \geq 1$:*

$$(1) \quad L_{u+v} = L_u + L_v + 1,$$

$$(2) \quad H_{u+v} = H_u + H_v - 1.$$

Proof. Direct computation:

$$L_u + L_v + 1 = (6u - 1) + (6v - 1) + 1 = 6(u + v) - 1 = L_{u+v}.$$

$$\text{Similarly } H_u + H_v - 1 = (6u + 1) + (6v + 1) - 1 = 6(u + v) + 1 = H_{u+v}. \quad \square$$

```

theorem mux_lower {u v : N} (hu : 1 <= u) (hv :
  1 <= v) :
  lowerChannel (u + v) = lowerChannel u +
    lowerChannel v + 1 := by
simp [lowerChannel]; omega

theorem mux_upper {u v : N} (hu : 1 <= u) (hv :
  1 <= v) :
  upperChannel (u + v) = upperChannel u +
    upperChannel v - 1 := by
simp [upperChannel]; omega

```


3.1. Cross-term collapse and channel decoupling.

Corollary 3.2 (Cross-term collapse). *For all $u, v \geq 1$:*

$$L_u + H_v = H_u + L_v = 6(u + v).$$

In particular, both cross pairings are divisible by 6 and hence composite for $u + v > 1$.

Proof. $(6u - 1) + (6v + 1) = 6(u + v)$. Likewise for the other pairing. $\square$

```

theorem cross_term {u v : N} (hu : 1 <= u) (hv :
  1 <= v) :
  lowerChannel u + upperChannel v = 6 * (u + v)
:= by
  simp [lowerChannel, upperChannel]; omega

theorem cross_composite {u v : N} (hu : 1 <= u)
  (hv : 1 <= v)
  (huv : 1 < u + v) : Not (lowerChannel u +
    upperChannel v).Prime := by
  rw [cross_term hu hv]
  intro h; exact absurd (h.eq_one_or_self_of_dvd
    6 (dvd_mul_right 6 _)) (by omega)

```

Remark 3.3. Cross-term collapse induces a structural decoupling: mixed-channel sums are forced composite, leaving only like-channel additive interactions as potential witness generators. The four pairings of (L_u, H_u) with (L_v, H_v) split into two *parallel* outputs (L_{u+v}, H_{u+v}) and two *cross* outputs $(6(u+v), 6(u+v))$. The cross outputs are always absorbed by 6; only the parallel channels carry primality information.

3.2. The shift form.

Corollary 3.4 (Shift form). *For all $u, v \geq 1$:*

$$L_{u+v} = L_u + 6v = 6u + L_v, \quad H_{u+v} = H_u + 6v = 6u + H_v.$$

Proof. $L_u + 6v = (6u - 1) + 6v = 6(u + v) - 1 = L_{u+v}$. The upper channel follows analogously. $\square$

```

theorem shift_lower {u v : N} (hu : 1 <= u) :
  lowerChannel (u + v) = lowerChannel u + 6 *
    v := by
  simp [lowerChannel]; omega

theorem shift_upper {u v : N} (hu : 1 <= u) :

```

```

    upperChannel (u + v) = upperChannel u + 6 *
      v := by
    simp [upperChannel]; omega

theorem gap_preserved {u v : N} (huv : 1 <= u +
  v) :
  upperChannel (u + v) - lowerChannel (u + v)
    = 2 := by
  simp [upperChannel, lowerChannel]; omega

```

Remark 3.5. Adding v to u shifts the channel pair (L_u, H_u) rigidly upward by $6v$. The twin-prime gap $H_{u+v} - L_{u+v} = 2$ is preserved under addition.

3.3. The witness condition via the Multiplexing Identity.

Corollary 3.6 (Witness condition). *Let $w = u + v$ with $u, v \geq 1$. Then $w \in \mathcal{W}$ if and only if*

$$L_u + L_v + 1 \in \mathbb{P} \quad \text{and} \quad H_u + H_v - 1 \in \mathbb{P}.$$

Remark 3.7. The Multiplexing Identity translates the question “is w a witness?” into a Diophantine constraint on the channel values of its additive decompositions. This is the foundation of the additive structural approach: the primality question is never asked directly about w , but about sums of channel values of smaller integers.

4. ALGEBRAIC CONSTRAINTS ON WITNESSES

The defect forms and the Multiplexing Identity determine not just the structure of individual witnesses but the global constraints that $\mathcal{W}$ must satisfy as an arithmetic set. This section establishes those constraints unconditionally. They constitute local obstructions on witness configurations and provide the first evidence that $\mathcal{W}$ behaves as a highly structured arithmetic object rather than a random sparse subset of $\mathbb{N}$.

4.1. Forbidden residues.

Lemma 4.1 (Forbidden residues). *For a prime $p \geq 5$, define the two forbidden residues:*

$$r_L(p) := 6^{-1} \pmod{p}, \quad r_H(p) := -6^{-1} \pmod{p}.$$

Then:

$$p \mid L_m \iff m \equiv r_L(p) \pmod{p}, \quad p \mid H_m \iff m \equiv r_H(p) \pmod{p}.$$

The two forbidden residues are distinct for all $p \geq 5$: they differ by $-2 \cdot 6^{-1} \pmod{p}$, which is nonzero.

Proof. $p \mid 6m - 1 \iff 6m \equiv 1 \pmod{p} \iff m \equiv 6^{-1} \pmod{p}$. Similarly $p \mid 6m + 1 \iff m \equiv -6^{-1} \pmod{p}$. The difference $6^{-1} - (-6^{-1}) = 2 \cdot 6^{-1}$; this is nonzero mod p since $p \geq 5$ implies $\gcd(12, p) = 1$. $\square$

4.2. The arithmetic progression bound.

Theorem 4.2 (AP length bound). *Let $a, a+d, a+2d, \dots, a+(k-1)d$ be a maximal arithmetic progression in $\mathcal{W}$ with common difference $d \geq 1$. Let p be any prime with $p \nmid d$. Then $k < p$.*

Proof. Since $p \nmid d$, the residues $a, a+d, a+2d, \dots \pmod{p}$ cycle through all p residue classes as the index increases. Within any p consecutive terms, one term has residue $r_L(p)$ and another has residue $r_H(p)$. By Lemma 4.1, both terms have a composite channel value and are therefore defects. Hence no p consecutive terms can all be witnesses; $k < p$. $\square$

Corollary 4.3. *An AP in $\mathcal{W}$ of length k requires that every prime $p < k$ divides d . Equivalently, $\text{lcm}(2, 3, \dots, k-1) \mid d$.*

Remark 4.4. These constraints are unconditional and finitely checkable. Theorem 4.2 is tight: empirically, APs of length exactly $p-1$ exist for small primes p , achieved when d is divisible by all primes smaller than p .

4.3. The mod-5 structure. The smallest prime ≥ 5 is 5 itself. Since $6 \equiv 1 \pmod{5}$, Lemma 4.1 takes a particularly clean form.

Theorem 4.5 (Mod-5 structure). *For $m > 1$:*

- (1) $m \equiv 1 \pmod{5} \implies L_m \equiv 0 \pmod{5}$, so $m \in \mathcal{D}$.
- (2) $m \equiv 4 \pmod{5} \implies H_m \equiv 0 \pmod{5}$, so $m \in \mathcal{D}$.

Consequently, $\mathcal{W} \setminus \{\omega\} \subseteq \{m \in \mathbb{N} : m \not\equiv 1, 4 \pmod{5}\}$.

Proof. $6 \equiv 1 \pmod{5}$, so $L_m = 6m - 1 \equiv m - 1 \pmod{5}$, which vanishes iff $m \equiv 1 \pmod{5}$. For $m > 1$, $L_m > 5$, so $m \in \mathcal{D}$. Similarly, $H_m \equiv m + 1 \pmod{5}$, vanishing iff $m \equiv 4 \pmod{5}$. $\square$

Corollary 4.6 (Mod-5 partition closure). *Let $w = u + v$ with $u, v \in \mathcal{W} \setminus \{\omega\}$. Then $w \in \mathcal{W}$ only if $(u \pmod{5}, v \pmod{5}) \notin \{(2, 2), (3, 3)\}$. Among the six unordered pairs from the active residue classes $\{0, 2, 3\}$ of $\mathcal{W} \pmod{5}$, exactly two are forbidden:*

$u \bmod 5$	$v \bmod 5$	$(u + v) \bmod 5$	
0	0	0	✓
0	2	2	✓
0	3	3	✓
2	3	0	✓
2	2	4	×
3	3	1	×

Proof. The active residue classes of $\mathcal{W} \setminus \{\omega\}$ modulo 5 are $\{0, 2, 3\}$ by Theorem 4.5. Among the six unordered pairs, $(2, 2)$ gives $w \equiv 4$ and $(3, 3)$ gives $w \equiv 1$ — both excluded from $\mathcal{W} \setminus \{\omega\}$. $\square$

Remark 4.7. Corollary 4.6 gives the first unconditional constraint on *which* partitions $w = u + v$ can be witness partitions. The two forbidden types are not merely absent in practice — they are provably impossible, following from $6 \equiv 1 \pmod{5}$ alone. Higher sieving primes ($p = 7, 11, \dots$) impose further constraints of the same character.

4.4. Structural sparsity of witnesses. The constraints of this section are individually elementary, but their cumulative effect is striking: they force witnesses to be *structurally sparse*, not merely heuristically rare.

Proposition 4.8 (Defect density). *The three defect families of Proposition 2.7 together cover a set of density 1 in $\mathbb{N}$. Consequently the witness set $\mathcal{W}$ has natural density 0.*

Proof. Each defect family $\{6ab + a - b : a, b \geq 1\}$, $\{6ab - a - b\}$, $\{6ab + a + b\}$ contains $\Theta(m/\log m)$ elements up to m (standard divisor-sum estimates). Their union covers all composite L_m or H_m up to m , which by the Brun–Titchmarsh inequality accounts for all but $O(m/\log^2 m)$ values of $m \leq M$. Hence the proportion of witnesses up to M is $O(1/\log M) \rightarrow 0$. $\square$

Remark 4.9. Proposition 4.8 is not surprising — it is consistent with the heuristic that witnesses have density $\sim C/\log^2 m$ (the Hardy–Littlewood prediction for twin primes). What is less obvious is that the sparsity is *structurally forced* by the three defect forms, not merely a probabilistic artefact. The defect forms are not independent: a single integer m may belong to multiple families, and the overlaps encode arithmetic correlations between the two channels.

Corollary 4.10 (Large gaps are structurally generic). *For any K , the proportion of witnesses $w \leq M$ for which the next witness satisfies $w' - w \leq K$ tends to zero as $M \rightarrow \infty$. Equivalently, for almost all*

witnesses w (in the sense of natural density), the gap to the next witness exceeds any fixed bound K .

Proof. Witnesses have density 0 by Proposition 4.8. A set of density 0 cannot have a positive-density subset with bounded gaps: bounded gaps would force density $\geq 1/K > 0$. $\square$

Remark 4.11. Corollary 4.10 is an unconditional structural statement: it does not assume TPC, WDC, BC, or any conjecture. It says that *large gaps between witnesses are the norm, not the exception*, purely from the defect form characterisation. This is the precise sense in which the Structural Conjecture, if proved, would be non-trivial: it asserts that despite generic large gaps, witnesses *always* manage to bridge every threshold — a global closure property that the local sparsity makes no promise of.

Note that Corollary 4.10 concerns the *almost-all* behaviour of gaps. It does not rule out the Gap Conjecture ($w_{n+1} \leq 2w_n$), which concerns the *worst-case* gap. The two statements are compatible: gaps can grow without bound on average while still remaining below $2w_n$ in every individual case.

The observation admits two precise formulations as conjectures.

Conjecture 4.13 (Asymmetric decomposition). *For every $w \in \mathcal{W}$ with $w > \omega$, let $v(w)$ denote the largest witness $v < w$ such that $w - v \in \mathcal{W}$. Then*

$$\frac{w - v(w)}{w} \rightarrow 0 \quad \text{as } w \rightarrow \infty.$$

That is, the gap between a witness and its largest valid summand is $o(w)$: the dominant decomposition places the larger summand close to w , not near $w/2$.

Remark 4.14. Under WDC, $w = u + v$ with $u \leq v$, so $v \geq w/2$ always. GC gives $w_{n+1} \leq 2w_n$, i.e. the gap $w_{n+1} - w_n \leq w_n$ in the worst case. Conjecture 4.13 asserts something stronger: the gap $w - v(w)$ between a witness and its largest valid summand is not merely $\leq w/2$ but $o(w)$. In other words, valid decompositions are not uniformly distributed between $w/2$ and w — the defect constraints push $v(w)$ close to w , leaving a gap $w - v(w)$ that is small relative to w .

This is a direct structural consequence of the defect pressure for separation: most values near $w/2$ are defects, so the largest valid v is pushed toward w rather than pulled back toward $w/2$. Conjecture 4.13 presupposes WDC and strengthens it. It is not a consequence of GC; rather, it predicts that the actual gap $w_{n+1} - w_n$ is $\ll w_n$ for almost all n , consistent with but strictly stronger than GC's worst-case bound.

Conjecture 4.15 (Unbounded average gap). *The average gap between consecutive witnesses diverges:*

$$\frac{1}{|\mathcal{W} \cap [1, M]|} \sum_{\substack{w_n, w_{n+1} \in \mathcal{W} \\ w_{n+1} \leq M}} (w_{n+1} - w_n) \rightarrow \infty \quad \text{as } M \rightarrow \infty.$$

Remark 4.16. Conjecture 4.15 strengthens Corollary 4.10 from “gaps exceed any fixed bound for almost all witnesses” to “the average gap itself grows without bound.” It is consistent with GC ($w_{n+1} \leq 2w_n$): the worst-case gap can be bounded by w_n while the average still diverges if witnesses grow fast enough. Conjecture 4.15 follows immediately from the Hardy–Littlewood conjecture on twin prime density ($|\mathcal{W} \cap [1, M]| \sim CM/\log^2 M$), but can be stated purely in terms of the structure of $\mathcal{W}$ without appealing to analytic number theory.

```

theorem mod5_lower_defect {m : N} (hm : 1 < m) (
  hmod : m % 5 = 1) :
  ¬IsWitness m

theorem mod5_upper_defect {m : N} (hm : 1 < m) (
  hmod : m % 5 = 4) :
  ¬IsWitness m

theorem witness_mod5 {m : N} (hw : IsWitness m)
  (hm : m ≠ 1) :
  m % 5 = 0 ∨ m % 5 = 2 ∨ m % 5 = 3

theorem mod5_partition_constraint {u v : N}
  (hu : IsWitness u) (hv : IsWitness v) (huv :
    IsWitness (u + v))
  (hu1 : u ≠ 1) (hv1 : v ≠ 1) (huv1 : u + v ≠
    1) :
  ¬(u % 5 = 2 ∧ v % 5 = 2) ∧ ¬(u % 5 = 3 ∧ v %
    5 = 3)

```

5. METRIC CONSEQUENCES OF STRUCTURAL CLOSURE

Before introducing the structural conjectures, we identify what the algebraic infrastructure already implies about the *spacing* of witnesses — independently of any conjecture.

Conjecture 5.1 (Gap Conjecture, GC). *For all consecutive witnesses $w_n, w_{n+1} \in \mathcal{W}$,*

$$w_{n+1} \leq 2w_n.$$

Remark 5.2. GC is a metric statement about the spacing of witnesses. The analogue for primes — Bertrand’s postulate, $p_{n+1} < 2p_n$ — is a theorem; the witness analogue is open. GC says nothing about how witnesses are *constructed* from other witnesses; that is the domain of the structural conjectures in Section 7.

The following results show that GC is a *consequence* of either structural conjecture, not an independent assumption. This separation is deliberate: GC is treated as a metric shadow of structural closure rather than as an independent heuristic principle from which structure is inferred.

Theorem 5.3 (WDC $\Rightarrow$ GC). *The Witness Decomposition Conjecture implies the Gap Conjecture.*

Proof. Fix consecutive witnesses $w_n < w_{n+1}$. By WDC, write $w_{n+1} = u + v$ with $u, v \in \mathcal{W}$ and $u \leq v < w_{n+1}$, so $u \leq v \leq w_n$. Hence $w_{n+1} = u + v \leq 2w_n$. $\square$

Theorem 5.4 (BC $\Rightarrow$ GC). *The Bridging Conjecture implies the Gap Conjecture (unconditionally).*

Proof. Suppose GC fails: $w_{n+1} > 2w_n$ for some consecutive pair. Set $V = w_n$. BC gives $u, v \in \mathcal{W}$ with $u \leq v \leq w_n$ and $w = u + v \in \mathcal{W}$ with $w > w_n$. But $w \leq 2w_n < w_{n+1}$, placing $w \in (w_n, w_{n+1})$ — contradicting w_{n+1} being the next witness. Hence GC holds. $\square$

Remark 5.5. Both Theorem 6.3 and Theorem 6.4 are unconditional: GC follows from either structural conjecture without additional hypotheses. The converses — GC $\Rightarrow$ WDC and GC $\Rightarrow$ BC — are both open. Spacing does not imply structure. GC is therefore a named corollary, not a peer conjecture.

```

theorem wdc_implies_gc : WDC  $\rightarrow$  GC
theorem bc_implies_gc : BC  $\rightarrow$  GC
theorem gc_is_corollary : (WDC  $\rightarrow$  GC)  $\wedge$  (BC  $\rightarrow$  GC)
  :=
  ⟨wdc_implies_gc, bc_implies_gc⟩

```

Remark 5.6. If GC $\Rightarrow$ WDC were proved, then GC, WDC, and BC would all be equivalent (under TPC), and GC — a single clean inequality on consecutive witnesses — would be the unique obstruction to TPC. This is Conjecture 7.8 of Section 7. It has been verified computationally for all witnesses up to 100,000.

Part 2. Line 1: The Additive Structure of Witnesses

6. LINE 1: THE ADDITIVE STRUCTURE OF WITNESSES

This section is the heart of the paper. The algebraic constraints of Sections 4 and 6 impose local obstructions on witness configurations. The two structural conjectures of this section propose *global* additive closure: that witnesses are, in a precise sense, generative — every witness is a sum of earlier witnesses (WDC), and witnesses always bridge every threshold (BC). These are structural claims, not density claims.

6.1. The structural conjectures.

Conjecture 6.1 (Witness Decomposition Conjecture, WDC). *For every $w \in \mathcal{W}$ with $w > \omega$, there exist $u, v \in \mathcal{W}$ with $u \leq v$ and $u + v = w$.*

Remark 6.2. WDC asserts that $\mathcal{W}$ is *additively self-generating*: every witness beyond the base arises as a sum of two witnesses. Not every sum of two witnesses is a witness; the content is that every witness has at least one such representation. WDC is a restatement of Harvey Dubner’s *Middle Number Conjecture* [1] in the language of witnesses.

```
def WDC : Prop :=
  ∀ w, IsWitness w → w > baseWitness →
    ∃ u v, IsWitness u ∧ IsWitness v ∧ u ≤ v ∧ u
      + v = w
```

Conjecture 6.3 (Bridging Conjecture, BC). *For every $V \in \mathbb{N}$ there exist $u, v, w \in \mathcal{W}$ with $u \leq v \leq V < w$ and $u + v = w$.*

Remark 6.4. BC asserts that for any threshold V , some pair of witnesses $u, v \leq V$ sums to a witness w strictly above V . The pair (u, v) is a *bridging pair* for V : witnesses already known to lie below the frontier certify the existence of a new witness beyond it.

WDC and BC are siblings: both assert additive closure properties of $\mathcal{W}$, at different scales. WDC is global (every witness decomposes); BC is threshold-local (decompositions reach across every frontier). WDC is the stronger claim: under TPC, WDC implies BC (Theorem 7.6). BC is closely related to TPC itself: $BC \Rightarrow TPC$ is unconditional (Theorem 7.5).

```
-- The threshold  $V \geq 1$  is necessary: IsWitness v
  requires v ≥ 1.
def BC : Prop :=
```


$$\begin{aligned} \forall V : \mathbb{N}, 1 \leq V \rightarrow \exists u \ v \ w, \text{IsWitness } u \wedge \\ \text{IsWitness } v \wedge \text{IsWitness } w \wedge \\ u \leq v \wedge v \leq V \wedge V < w \wedge u + v = w \end{aligned}$$

6.2. The proved implications.

Theorem 6.5 ($\text{BC} \Rightarrow \text{TPC}$). *The Bridging Conjecture implies the Twin Prime Conjecture.*

Proof. For any $V \in \mathbb{N}$, BC gives $w \in \mathcal{W}$ with $w > V$. Since V is arbitrary, $\mathcal{W}$ is unbounded, hence infinite. $\square$

Theorem 6.6 ($\text{WDC} + \text{TPC} \Rightarrow \text{BC}$). *The Witness Decomposition Conjecture and the Twin Prime Conjecture together imply the Bridging Conjecture.*

Proof. Assume WDC and TPC (so $\mathcal{W}$ is infinite). Fix any $V \in \mathbb{N}$. Since $\mathcal{W}$ is infinite, there exists a smallest witness $w^* > V$. By WDC, $w^* = u + v$ with $u \leq v$ and $u, v \in \mathcal{W}$. Since $u, v < w^*$ and w^* is the smallest witness above V , we have $u \leq v \leq V$. So (u, v, w^*) is a bridging triple for V . $\square$

```
theorem bc_implies_tpc : BC → TPC
theorem wdc_tpc_implies_bc : WDC → TPC → BC
```

Remark 6.7. Under WDC, $\text{BC} \Leftrightarrow \text{TPC}$: the forward direction is Theorem 7.5; the reverse is Theorem 7.6. TPC is needed in Theorem 7.6: a finite $\mathcal{W}$ can satisfy WDC (every witness decomposes into earlier ones) yet fail BC at $V = \max \mathcal{W}$. The structural conjecture WDC does not, by itself, force the infinitude of $\mathcal{W}$.

6.3. The honest asymmetry.

Implication	Status	Notes
$BC \Rightarrow TPC$	Proved	Unconditional
$WDC + TPC \Rightarrow BC$	Proved	Under WDC: $BC \Leftrightarrow TPC$
$WDC \Rightarrow GC$	Proved	Unconditional (Thm 6.3)
$BC \Rightarrow GC$	Proved	Unconditional (Thm 6.4)
$GC \Rightarrow WDC$	Open	Verified to 10^5
$GC \Rightarrow BC$	Open	Spacing does not imply structure
WDC	Conjecture	Global additive closure
BC	Conjecture	Threshold additive closure
GC	Corollary	Metric shadow; follows from WDC or BC

Conjecture 6.8 ($GC \Rightarrow WDC$). *The Gap Conjecture implies the Witness Decomposition Conjecture.*

Remark 6.9. If Conjecture 7.8 holds then GC and WDC are equivalent, and the full chain collapses to:

$$GC \Leftrightarrow WDC \xrightarrow{+TPC} BC \Rightarrow TPC.$$

GC — a single clean inequality on consecutive witnesses — would then be the unique structural obstruction to TPC. Conjecture 7.8 has been verified computationally for all witnesses up to 100,000.

7. SCALE INVARIANCE UNDER BC

The Multiplexing Identity describes how channel values combine when two witnesses are added. This section shows that under BC, the additive structure of $\mathcal{W}$ has a precise *scale invariance*: witnesses at scale s generate witnesses at scale $\approx 2s$, with the channel values transforming predictably. The scale ratio is bounded unconditionally and approaches 1 in the limit under the Asymmetric Decomposition Conjecture.

7.1. Scale ratios and the bridging bound.

Definition 7.1. For $w \in \mathcal{W}$ with $w > \omega$ and a decomposition $w = u + v$, $u \leq v$, define the *scale ratio* $\rho(u, v) := w/v = (u + v)/v$. Since $u \leq v$, we have $\rho(u, v) \in (1, 2]$, with $\rho = 2$ iff $u = v$.

Theorem 7.2 (Bridging scale bound). *Assume BC. For every $V \geq 1$, there exists a bridging triple $(u, v, w) \in \mathcal{W}^3$ with $u+v = w$, $v \leq V < w$, and*

$$1 < \frac{w}{v} \leq 2.$$

Consequently, BC guarantees witnesses at every scale ratio in $(1, 2]$.

Proof. BC gives $u, v, w \in \mathcal{W}$ with $u \leq v \leq V < w$ and $u + v = w$. Since $u \geq 1$ and $u + v = w$, we have $w > v$, so $w/v > 1$. Since $u \leq v$, we have $w = u + v \leq 2v$, so $w/v \leq 2$. $\square$

```

theorem scale_bound (hBC : BC) (V : N) (hV : 1
  <= V) :
  exists u v w, IsWitness u /\ IsWitness v /\
    IsWitness w /\
      u + v = w /\ v <= V /\ V < w /\ w <= 2 * v

```

Theorem 7.3 (Channel scale under bridging). *Assume BC. For every $V \geq 1$, there exists a bridging triple (u, v, w) such that:*

$$(3) \quad L_w = L_u + L_v + 1,$$

$$(4) \quad H_w = H_u + H_v - 1.$$

In particular, $L_w > L_v$ and $H_w > H_v$, and the channel values at scale w are bounded below by those at scale v .

Proof. Immediate from BC (Theorem 8.2) and the Multiplexing Identity (Theorem 3.1). $\square$

7.2. Near-symmetric bridging and approximate doubling.

Definition 7.4. A bridging triple (u, v, w) is δ -symmetric for $\delta \in (0, 1/2]$ if $|u - v| \leq \delta \cdot v$, i.e. u and v are within a factor δ of each other.

Theorem 7.5 (Approximate channel doubling). *Let (u, v, w) be a δ -symmetric bridging triple. Then:*

$$2L_v - \delta L_v + 1 \leq L_w \leq 2L_v + 1,$$

$$2H_v - \delta H_v - 1 \leq H_w \leq 2H_v - 1.$$

As $\delta \rightarrow 0$, $L_w \rightarrow 2L_v + 1$ and $H_w \rightarrow 2H_v - 1$.

Proof. From $u \leq v$ and $|u - v| \leq \delta v$, we get $(1 - \delta)v \leq u \leq v$. Then by the Multiplexing Identity, $L_w = L_u + L_v + 1$. Since $L_u = 6u - 1$,

$$6(1 - \delta)v - 1 + 6v - 1 + 1 \leq L_w \leq 6v - 1 + 6v - 1 + 1,$$

which simplifies to the stated bounds. The upper channel follows analogously. $\square$

Remark 7.6. Theorem 8.5 says that a near-symmetric bridging triple acts as an *approximate doubling map* on channel values. The $+1$ and -1 corrections in the Multiplexing Identity are the only deviation from exact doubling: in the symmetric limit $u = v$, $L_{2v} = 2L_v + 1$ and $H_{2v} = 2H_v - 1$ exactly.

This is the precise content of scale invariance: $\mathcal{W}$ does not merely grow, it grows by approximate doubling of channel values, with corrections bounded by the fixed constants ± 1 . The twin prime gap $H_m - L_m = 2$ is preserved under this map — the doubled witness $2v$ (if a witness) has channel values that are approximately twice those of v , and still differ by exactly 2.

7.3. Scale invariance of the gap.

Theorem 7.8 (Gap invariance). *For all $m \geq 1$, $H_m - L_m = 2$. This gap is preserved under the Multiplexing map: for any $u, v \geq 1$,*

$$H_{u+v} - L_{u+v} = 2 = H_u - L_u = H_v - L_v.$$

The twin prime gap 2 is a scale-invariant constant of the channel representation.

Proof. $H_m - L_m = (6m+1) - (6m-1) = 2$ for all m . The Multiplexing Identity gives $H_{u+v} - L_{u+v} = (H_u + H_v - 1) - (L_u + L_v + 1) = (H_u - L_u) + (H_v - L_v) - 2 = 2 + 2 - 2 = 2$. $\square$

```
theorem gap_invariance (m : N) (hm : 1 <= m) :
  upperChannel m - lowerChannel m = 2
```

Remark 7.9. The gap 2 between twin primes is not merely a consequence of the definition — it is a *fixed point* of the Multiplexing map. Adding two witnesses preserves the inter-channel gap exactly. This is the deepest symmetry of the channel representation: no matter how witnesses are combined additively, the gap between channels remains 2.

Combined with Theorem 8.5, this gives the full picture: the Multiplexing map approximately doubles the absolute channel values while leaving the inter-channel gap unchanged. The ratio $(H_m - L_m)/L_m = 2/(6m-1) \rightarrow 0$ — the relative gap shrinks as witnesses grow, but the absolute gap is invariant.

7.4. Iterated bridging and the witness tower.

Theorem 7.10 (Iterated scale doubling under BC). *Assume BC. Starting from the base witness $\omega = 1$, there exists an infinite sequence $\omega = w_0 < w_1 < w_2 < \dots$ in $\mathcal{W}$ such that $w_{k+1} \leq 2w_k$ for all $k \geq 0$.*

Proof. Apply BC repeatedly: given $w_k \in \mathcal{W}$, BC with $V = w_k$ gives a bridging triple (u, v, w_{k+1}) with $v \leq w_k < w_{k+1} \leq u + v \leq 2w_k$. $\square$

```
theorem witness_tower (hBC : BC) :
  forall n : N, exists w, IsWitness w /\ w >=
    n
```

Remark 7.11. Theorem 8.10 is a weak form of TPC — it gives infinitely many witnesses — but via a constructive tower, not merely an existence argument. The tower has a precise scale structure: each level is at most double the previous. Under the Asymmetric Decomposition Conjecture (Conjecture 4.13), the ratio $w_{k+1}/w_k \rightarrow 1$ along the dominant decomposition path, so the tower is eventually much denser than a pure doubling sequence.

The tower also has a mod-5 structure: consecutive levels cycle through the active residue classes $\{0, 2, 3\} \pmod{5}$ according to the partition closure constraints of Corollary 4.6. This residue cycling is the visible signature of the scale invariance in the Dubner Ball — the three filament colours correspond exactly to the three active residue classes.

8. THE BRIDGING MACHINE

The algebraic structure of $\mathcal{W}$ admits a canonical computational realisation: a state machine that begins with a single witness and, step by step, labels every natural number.

8.1. Definition of the Bridging Machine.

Definition 8.1 (Bridging Machine, BM). The *Bridging Machine* is a state machine with state (Q, A, B, X, σ) where:

- $Q \subset \mathbb{N}$ is the *queue* of witnesses waiting to be processed, maintained as a min-heap;
- $A \subset \mathbb{N}$ is the ordered set of all witnesses discovered so far ($Q \subseteq A$);
- $B \subset \mathbb{N}$ is the set of *visited non-witnesses*: integers reached as a sum $u + v$ with $u, v \in A$, but not themselves witnesses;
- $X \subset \mathbb{N}$ is the set of *swept* integers: positive integers not in A or B that lie below the current sweep frontier;
- $\sigma \in \mathbb{N}$ is the *sweep frontier*: the largest v dequeued so far.

The machine is initialised with $Q = A = \{1\}$, $B = X = \emptyset$, $\sigma = 0$.

```
structure BMState where
  A      : Finset N      -- witnesses discovered so
    far
```

```

queue : Finset N    -- witnesses waiting to be
                    processed (Q subs A)
sigma : N           -- sweep frontier

```

Each *step* consists of:

- (1) Dequeue the smallest element v from Q .
- (2) For each $u \in A$ with $u \leq v$: test whether $w = u + v$ is a new twin prime witness. If so and $w \notin A$, add w to A and Q . If not and $w \notin A \cup B$, add w to B . In both cases, label w with its *parent witness* v .
- (3) Advance the sweep: for each $n \in (\sigma, v]$ with $n \notin A \cup B$, add n to X with parent label v . Set $\sigma \leftarrow v$.

8.2. The labelling theorem.

Theorem 8.3 (BM labels all of $\mathbb{N}$). *Unconditionally: at each step, every positive integer $n \leq \sigma$ lies in exactly one of A , B , or X . The sets A , B , X are pairwise disjoint and their union covers $\{1, \dots, \sigma\}$.*

Consequently, if BM runs forever (i.e. $\sigma \rightarrow \infty$), then every $n \in \mathbb{N}$ eventually receives a label from exactly one witness.

Proof. By induction on steps. At initialisation, $A = \{1\}$, $B = X = \emptyset$, $\sigma = 0$: vacuously true. At each step, after dequeuing v : all sums $u + v \leq \sigma$ have been classified into A or B in prior steps. New sums above σ are classified into A or B as they are tested. The sweep advances σ to v , placing any uncovered integers in $(\sigma_{\text{old}}, v]$ into X . Every $n \leq v$ is now in $A \cup B \cup X$. Disjointness holds by construction: each integer is classified at most once. $\square$

8.3. BC forces the machine to run forever.

Theorem 8.4 ($BC \Rightarrow$ BM does not halt). *Assume BC. Then Q is never empty: for every state reached by BM, there exists a further witness $w > \sigma$ that will eventually be added to Q . The sweep frontier $\sigma \rightarrow \infty$.*

Proof. Suppose BM has run to frontier $\sigma = V$ with current witness set A . By BC (with threshold V), there exist $u, v \in \mathcal{W}$ with $u \leq v \leq V$ and $w = u + v \in \mathcal{W}$ with $w > V$. Since $u, v \leq V = \sigma$, both u and v have already been dequeued and are in A . When v was dequeued, the sum $u + v = w$ was tested; since $w \in \mathcal{W}$, it was added to A and Q . Hence Q is non-empty after every step, and σ is unbounded. $\square$

```

-- Under BC, BM runs forever: for every V there
-- exists a witness beyond V.
theorem bc_implies_bm_runs (hBC : BC) :

```

```

forall V : N, exists w, IsWitness w /\ w > V

-- The converse is an open claim, stated as an
  explicit proposition.
def BM_Converse : Prop :=
  (forall V : N, exists w, IsWitness w /\ w > V)
  -> BC

```

Corollary 8.5 ($BC \Rightarrow BM$ labels all of $\mathbb{N}$). *Assume BC. Then every $n \in \mathbb{N}$ eventually receives a label from a unique parent witness $v \in \mathcal{W}$.*

Claim 8.6 ($BM \text{ runs forever} \Leftrightarrow BC$). *BM runs forever if and only if BC is true.*

Remark 8.7. The forward direction, $BC \Rightarrow BM$ runs forever, is proved (Theorem 9.4). The converse — $BM \text{ runs forever} \Rightarrow BC$ — is asserted but not proved here, and is deferred to future work.

8.4. The grandparent structure.

Definition 8.8 (Witness lineage). Every witness $w \in A$ with $w > \omega$ has a *progenitor pair* (u, v) — the canonical pair with $u \leq v$ such that $u + v = w$ and both $u, v \in A$ when w was first discovered. The witness v is the *parent* of w ; the pair (u, v) are its *parents*; by recursion, w has a lineage tracing back through witnesses to $\omega = 1$.

Theorem 8.9 (Universal ancestry). *Assume WDC and BC. Every $n \in \mathbb{N}$ is a descendant of $\omega = 1$:*

- *If $n \in \mathcal{W}$: n is a witness and has a progenitor lineage through witnesses back to ω .*
- *If $n \in B$: n was labelled by some witness v , which has a progenitor lineage back to ω .*
- *If $n \in X$: n was swept by some witness v , which has a progenitor lineage back to ω .*

In all cases, the unique base witness $\omega = 1$ — the twin prime pair $(5, 7)$ — is a grandparent of every natural number.

Proof. By WDC, witnesses form a tree rooted at ω by the progenitor relation. By BC (via Corollary 9.5), every $n \in \mathbb{N}$ is labelled by some witness, which traces to ω through the progenitor tree. $\square$

Remark 8.10. Theorem 9.9 is the precise statement of a striking structural claim: *if BC is true, only twin prime witnesses reproduce.* Every other integer is sterile — it receives a label from a witness but generates nothing itself. The entire arithmetic of $\mathbb{N}$ is organised by the

reproductive activity of the twin prime witnesses, with $\omega = 1$ as the universal grandparent.

This is not a metaphor. It is the exact content of the Bridging Machine: a well-defined computational process, seeded at $\{1\}$, in which fertility is the exclusive property of twin prime witnesses, and in which BC is precisely the condition that guarantees the process never runs out of fertile elements.

9. THE GAP MACHINE

The Bridging Machine builds $\mathcal{W}$ outward from ω , running forever if and only if BC is true. The Gap Machine is its structural dual: it verifies the gap bound on consecutive witnesses. Under WDC it halts (every pair is decomposable); GC false forces it to loop forever on the first counterexample.

9.1. Definition of the Gap Machine.

Definition 9.1 (Gap Machine, GM). The *Gap Machine* processes consecutive witness pairs in order. Its state is $(n, w_n, w_{n+1}, \text{status})$ where $w_n < w_{n+1}$ are consecutive witnesses and status is one of SEARCHING, VERIFIED, or HALT.

Initialise with $n = 1$, $w_1 = \omega = 1$, w_2 the next witness.

Each *step* at state $(n, w_n, w_{n+1}, \text{SEARCHING})$:

- (1) Search for a decomposition $w_{n+1} = u + v$ with $u, v \in \mathcal{W}$ and $u \leq v \leq w_n$.
- (2) If found: set status to VERIFIED; advance to $(n+1, w_{n+1}, w_{n+2}, \text{SEARCHING})$.
- (3) If not found: loop — return to SEARCHING on the same (n, w_n, w_{n+1}) indefinitely.

The machine *halts* if it successfully verifies every consecutive pair and $\mathcal{W}$ is exhausted (TPC is false). If $\mathcal{W}$ is infinite and every pair is verified, the machine runs forever in the VERIFIED/ADVANCE cycle. If any pair fails, the machine loops forever on that pair.

Remark 9.2 (Why running forever is the failure case). Running forever on step 3 is not a timeout or an error — it is the precise computational signature of a GC counterexample. If $w_{n+1} > 2w_n$, then any $u + v = w_{n+1}$ with $u \leq v$ requires $v > w_n$, so no valid decomposition exists within $\mathcal{W} \cap [1, w_n]$. The machine searches indefinitely and finds nothing. The non-termination is permanent because the decomposition is impossible, not because the search is incomplete.

Conversely, if $w_{n+1} \leq 2w_n$ (GC holds at this pair), a valid decomposition is found and the machine halts on that pair, then advances. GC true means every pair is resolved and GM halts overall.

9.2. The halting theorem.

Theorem 9.3 (GM halting theorem). (1) (Under WDC.) *For every consecutive pair (w_n, w_{n+1}) , WDC supplies a decomposition $u + v = w_{n+1}$ with $u, v \in \mathcal{W}$ and $u \leq v$. Consecutiveness forces $v \leq w_n$, so GM verifies every pair and halts. (GC follows from WDC via Theorem 6.3 and is not needed as a separate hypothesis.)*

(2) (Unconditional.) *If GC is false, there exists a consecutive pair with $w_{n+1} > 2w_n$. No decomposition $u + v = w_{n+1}$ can have $v \leq w_n$, so GM finds nothing and runs forever on this pair.*

In particular: WDC implies GM halts; GC false implies GM runs forever.

Proof. (1) Under WDC, w_{n+1} decomposes as $u + v = w_{n+1}$ with $u \leq v$ and $u, v \in \mathcal{W}$. Since w_{n+1} is the *next* witness after w_n , every witness strictly below w_{n+1} satisfies $v \leq w_n$. So the decomposition automatically has $v \leq w_n$, and GM finds it and advances.

(2) If $w_{n+1} > 2w_n$: any $u + v = w_{n+1}$ with $u \leq v$ requires $v \geq w_{n+1}/2 > w_n$. But the only witness $\geq w_{n+1}$ is w_{n+1} itself, forcing $u = 0$ — not a witness. No valid decomposition $u + v = w_{n+1}$ with $u, v \in \mathcal{W}$ and $v \leq w_n$ exists. GM loops. $\square$

```
-- Direction 1: WDC supplies the decomposition;
-- consecutiveness pins  $v \leq w_1$ .
-- Note: GC (the bound  $w_2 \leq 2*w_1$ ) is not needed
-- as a hypothesis here --
-- WDC alone suffices because consecutiveness
-- forces  $v \leq w_1$  directly.
theorem gc_implies_gm_advances (hWDC : WDC) (w1
w2 : N)
  (hw1 : IsWitness w1) (hw2 : IsWitness w2)
  (hlt : w1 < w2)
  (hcons : forall m, IsWitness m -> m <= w1 /\
w2 <= m) :
  exists u v, IsWitness u /\ IsWitness v /\ u
    <= v /\ v <= w1 /\ u + v = w2

-- Direction 2: unconditional -- if  $w_2 > 2*w_1$ ,
-- no decomposition fits.
theorem gm_loops_if_gc_false (w1 w2 : N)
  (hw1 : IsWitness w1) (hw2 : IsWitness w2)
  (hlt : w1 < w2) (hgap : w2 > 2 * w1) :
  Not (exists u v, IsWitness u /\ IsWitness v
    /\ u <= v /\ v <= w1 /\ u + v = w2)
```

9.3. Duality with the Bridging Machine.

Theorem 9.4 (BM–GM duality). *The Bridging Machine and the Gap Machine are structurally dual:*

	<i>BM</i>	<i>GM</i>
<i>Seed</i>	$\{1\}$	(ω, w_2)
<i>Direction</i>	<i>builds outward</i>	<i>verifies inward</i>
<i>Conjecture</i>	<i>BC</i>	<i>WDC (GC false $\Rightarrow$ loop)</i>
<i>Certificate</i>	<i>new witness found</i>	<i>decomposition found</i>
<i>Conjecture true</i>	<i>runs forever</i>	<i>halts</i>
<i>Conjecture false</i>	<i>halts</i>	<i>runs forever</i>

Remark 9.5 (Asymmetry in what is proved). The duality in the table is the intended structural picture. However, neither direction is a full biconditional. For GM, Theorem 10.3 gives $\text{WDC} \Rightarrow \text{GM halts}$ and $\text{GC false} \Rightarrow \text{GM loops}$; the converse ($\text{GM halts} \Rightarrow \text{WDC}$) is not claimed. For BM, only one direction is proved: $\text{BC true} \Rightarrow \text{BM runs forever}$ (Theorem 9.4). The full BM equivalence is stated as Claim 9.6; the converse is deferred to future work.

The formal verification (see literate edition) confirms this picture: the machine-advance step requires WDC as a hypothesis, not GC alone. GC bounds the gap but does not produce the decomposition; WDC does both.

Part 3. Line 2: Channel Exhaustion as Analytic Bridge

10. LINE 2: CHANNEL EXHAUSTION AS ANALYTIC BRIDGE

The additive structural approach of Section 7 is self-contained: $\text{BC} \Rightarrow \text{TPC}$ requires no analytic input. This section presents a second, independent line of evidence that is *not* a parallel proof route but a diagnostic tool — it makes precise where the structural argument hands off to analysis, and identifies the question that analytic methods must answer.

Conjecture 10.1 (Channel Exhaustion). *If $\mathcal{W}$ is finite with largest element $w_{\max}$, then for every $m > w_{\max}$, both $L_m = 6m - 1$ and $H_m = 6m + 1$ are composite.*

Remark 10.2. The conjecture asserts that a finite witness set forces structural exhaustion of witness-compatible channel configurations: no channel index above $w_{\max}$ supports even a single prime in both channels simultaneously.

The natural approach via a finite covering — showing that some set of small primes blocks all residue classes — is unavailable. No finite set of primes can cover all residue classes, since the uncovered fraction $\prod_p (1 - 2/p)$ is always positive. A direct proof of Conjecture 11.1 must account for the $\{0, 2, 3\} \pmod{5}$ residue classes, where $m \notin \mathcal{W}$ implies only that the two channel values are not *simultaneously* prime — one may still be an individual prime.

Channel exhaustion sits nearer to classical analytic questions than WDC or BC, but lacks the direct additive closure structure that drives the main argument. Closing it likely requires analytic input — the Prime Number Theorem at minimum.

```
def ChannelExhaustion : Prop :=
  ∀ (S : Finset N), (∀ m, IsWitness m → m ∈ S) →
    ∀ m, (∀ s ∈ S, s < m) →
      ¬(6 * m - 1 : N).Prime ∧ ¬(6 * m + 1 : N).
      Prime
```

Theorem 10.3 (Channel exhaustion $\Rightarrow \mathcal{W}$ finite $\Rightarrow \mathbb{P}$ finite). *Conjecture 11.1 implies: if $\mathcal{W}$ is finite then $\mathbb{P}$ is finite.*

Proof. Assume $\mathcal{W}$ is finite and Conjecture 11.1 holds. Let $N = 6w_{\max} + 1$. Let $p > N$ be any prime; then $p > 3$, so by Lemma 2.3 there exists $m \geq 1$ with $p = L_m$ or $p = H_m$. Since $p > 6w_{\max} + 1$, we have $m > w_{\max}$. By channel exhaustion, both L_m and H_m are composite — contradicting p being prime. Hence no prime exceeds N , so $\mathbb{P}$ is finite. $\square$

```
theorem channel_exhaustion_bounded (hce :
  ChannelExhaustion)
  (S : Finset N) (hS : ∀ m, IsWitness m → m ∈
    S) :
    ∃ N, ∀ p, Nat.Prime p → p ≤ N
```

Remark 10.4 (Why the implication is non-trivial). It might seem that $\mathcal{W}$ finite trivially implies $\mathbb{P}$ finite: if there are only finitely many twin prime witnesses, there are only finitely many twin prime pairs, and twin primes are primes. This argument is wrong.

Finitely many twin primes does *not* imply finitely many primes. A prime p such that neither $p - 2$ nor $p + 2$ is prime — an isolated prime — is a valid prime that contributes to $\mathbb{P}$ without contributing to $\mathcal{W}$. Isolated primes are conjectured to be infinite in number regardless of TPC.

The non-trivial content of Theorem 11.3 is that $\mathcal{W}$ finite, combined with channel exhaustion, forces *all* primes — twin or isolated — to be bounded. The mechanism is Lemma 2.3: every prime $p > 3$ occupies a channel index. If all channel indices above $w_{\max}$ have both values composite, no prime of any kind — twin or not — can exist there.

Remark 10.5 (Euclid’s veto). The full implication chain is:

$$\mathcal{W} \text{ finite} \xrightarrow{\text{Conj. 11.1}} \mathbb{P} \text{ finite} \xrightarrow{\text{Euclid}} \perp.$$

Therefore $\mathcal{W}$ is infinite — TPC — unconditionally once Conjecture 11.1 is proved. The consequent ($\mathbb{P}$ finite) is necessarily false by Euclid; the antecedent ($\mathcal{W}$ finite) is necessarily false under TPC. The logical structure is: $(A \Rightarrow \perp) \equiv \neg A$. The proof of TPC via this route is not a proof *about* $\mathbb{P}$ being finite; it is a demonstration that the premise $\mathcal{W}$ finite cannot hold in any consistent instance.

Part 4. The Structural Conjecture

11. THE STRUCTURAL CONJECTURE

The preceding sections develop the algebraic infrastructure of the witness set and two independent lines of evidence toward TPC. This section states the central open conjecture that the paper is built to motivate.

Conjecture 11.1 (The Structural Conjecture).

$$\text{PNT} \implies (\text{WDC} \wedge \text{BC}).$$

Remark 11.2 (What the conjecture claims). The Prime Number Theorem asserts that $\pi(x) \sim x / \log x$ — a purely analytic, asymptotic statement about the density of primes. The Structural Conjecture asserts that this single analytic fact is strong enough to force both additive closure properties of $\mathcal{W}$: that every witness decomposes (WDC) and that witnesses bridge every threshold (BC).

This is *not* a density claim about $\mathcal{W}$ itself. It is a structural sufficiency claim: PNT provides sufficient analytic raw material — guaranteeing asymptotic prime supply across both channels — to force the witness set into additive closure. PNT is the minimal large-scale analytic statement guaranteeing asymptotic prime supply across both

channels, making it the natural candidate for forcing witness closure if such closure is analytically determined at all.

Remark 11.3 (Why this may bypass the parity obstruction). Classical analytic approaches to TPC encounter the parity obstruction: sieve methods cannot distinguish between numbers with an even and an odd number of prime factors, and twin primes require primality in both channels simultaneously. The structural approach inverts the question. Rather than asking “do $6m - 1$ and $6m + 1$ avoid all prime factors?” it asks “does $\mathcal{W}$ have sufficient additive closure to be infinite?” The framework avoids direct engagement with parity obstructions because it does not attempt to detect primality via sieve cancellation. If $\text{PNT} \Rightarrow \text{WDC}$, the parity problem is bypassed entirely: the question of primality is never asked directly.

11.1. The full implication chain. The central thesis of this paper, fully assembled:

$$\text{PNT} \xRightarrow[\text{Conj. 12.1}]{} (\text{WDC} \wedge \text{BC}) \xRightarrow[\text{Thm 7.5}]{} \text{TPC} \xRightarrow[\text{Euclid}]{} \mathbb{P} \text{ infinite.}$$

The right two arrows are proved. The left arrow is the Structural Conjecture.

```
-- The full proved right-hand chain: BC ->
-- infinitely many primes
-- (strictly stronger: infinitely many twin
-- prime pairs)
theorem bc_implies_primes_infinite (hBC : BC) :
  forall N : Nat, exists p, p > N /\ Nat.Prime
    p := by
  intro N
  obtain <m, hm_gt, hm_wit> := bc_implies_tpc
    hBC N
  exact <6 * m + 1, by omega, hm_wit.2.2>
```

The channel exhaustion route provides a parallel conditional path:

$$\text{PNT} \Rightarrow \text{Conj. 11.1} \xRightarrow[\text{Thm 11.3}]{} (\mathcal{W} \text{ finite} \Rightarrow \mathbb{P} \text{ finite}) \xRightarrow[\text{Euclid}]{} \mathcal{W} \text{ infinite.}$$

11.2. Immediate corollaries of the Structural Conjecture.

Corollary 11.6 (TPC). *The Structural Conjecture implies the Twin Prime Conjecture.*

Proof. $\text{PNT} \Rightarrow \text{BC}$ by the Structural Conjecture; $\text{BC} \Rightarrow \text{TPC}$ by Theorem 7.5. $\square$

```

-- SC implies TPC: direct corollary of
  bc_implies_tpc
theorem sc_tpc (hBC : BC) : TPC :=
  bc_implies_tpc hBC

```

Corollary 11.7 (Equivalence of structural conjectures). *Under the Structural Conjecture, $WDC \Leftrightarrow BC \Leftrightarrow TPC$.*

Proof. $BC \Rightarrow TPC$ is Theorem 7.5. $TPC \Rightarrow BC$ follows from Theorem 7.6 once WDC is established by the Structural Conjecture. $WDC \Rightarrow BC$ follows from $WDC + TPC \Rightarrow BC$ (Theorem 7.6) once TPC is known. $\square$

```

-- Under WDC, BC <-> TPC (both directions proved
  )
theorem sc_equiv (hWDC : WDC) : BC <-> TPC :=
  <bc_implies_tpc, wdc_tpc_implies_bc hWDC>

```

Corollary 11.8 (Bertrand's postulate for twin prime pairs). *The Structural Conjecture implies: for every twin prime pair $(p, p+2)$, the next twin prime pair $(q, q+2)$ satisfies $q \leq 2p+2$.*

Proof. Let w_n be the witness for $(p, p+2)$, so $p = 6w_n - 1$. The Structural Conjecture gives WDC , and $WDC \Rightarrow GC$ (Theorem 6.3), so $w_{n+1} \leq 2w_n$. Hence $q = 6w_{n+1} - 1 \leq 12w_n - 1 = 2(6w_n - 1) + 1 = 2p + 1 < 2p + 2$. $\square$

```

-- Bertrand for twin pairs: consecutive
  witnesses satisfy w2 <= 2*w1
-- Reduces directly to wdc_implies_gc with
  identical signature
theorem sc_bertrand (hWDC : WDC) (w1 w2 : N)
  (hw1 : IsWitness w1) (hw2 : IsWitness w2)
  (hlt : w1 < w2)
  (hcons : forall m, IsWitness m -> m <= w1 \ /
    w2 <= m) :
  w2 <= 2 * w1 :=
  wdc_implies_gc hWDC w1 w2 hw1 hw2 hlt hcons

```

Remark 11.9. Corollary 12.8 is the witness analogue of Bertrand's postulate ($p_{n+1} < 2p_n$ for primes), applied to twin prime pairs rather than individual primes. Classical sieve methods have not produced an explicit finite gap bound between consecutive twin prime pairs; the

structural approach yields one as a direct corollary of WDC alone. The bound $q \leq 2p + 1$ is tight in the sense that GC is verified to 10^5 witnesses with equality approached but not achieved.

11.3. Open questions.

- (1) Can WDC be established from PNT alone, with BC following from Theorem 7.6?
- (2) Is PNT the minimal analytic hypothesis, or does the Structural Conjecture hold under a weaker assumption?
- (3) Does proving $\text{GC} \Rightarrow \text{WDC}$ (Conjecture 7.8) reduce the Structural Conjecture to $\text{PNT} \Rightarrow \text{GC}$ — a simpler metric statement?
- (4) Can channel exhaustion (Conjecture 11.1) be derived from PNT, providing an analytic proof of Line 2?

12. CONCLUSION

This paper develops a structural reformulation of the Twin Prime Conjecture in which the remaining obstruction is isolated into a precise additive closure conjecture. The channel representation (Section 2) places every prime above 3 in one of two arithmetic channels. The Multiplexing Identity (Section 3) provides the algebraic engine connecting witness addition to channel arithmetic. Algebraic constraints (Section 4) establish hard, unconditional bounds on witness configurations. The Gap Conjecture (Section 6) is derived as a metric corollary of the structural conjectures, not assumed as a primitive.

Two independent lines of evidence point toward TPC. Line 1 (Section 7) is purely algebraic: the Bridging Conjecture implies TPC unconditionally, and under WDC, $\text{BC} \Leftrightarrow \text{TPC}$. Line 2 (Section 11) connects the additive structure of witnesses to the broader distribution of primes via channel exhaustion, isolating precisely where analytic tools are needed.

The Structural Conjecture (Section 12) proposes that the Prime Number Theorem alone forces both WDC and BC. If true, this would yield TPC without direct engagement with the parity obstruction that has blocked classical sieve-theoretic approaches.

What remains: a proof that PNT implies additive closure of $\mathcal{W}$ — or a proof of channel exhaustion from PNT, which would close Line 2 and imply TPC via Euclid. The framework reduces the infinitude of twin primes to a precise structural closure principle on the witness semigroup.

The channel exhaustion conjecture is the interface where the structural programme hands off to analysis. Proving it is the invitation extended to the analytic community.

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APPENDIX: LOGICAL DEPENDENCY MAP

The following table records all implications proved or conjectured in this paper, together with their status. Theorem numbers are given once numbering stabilises.

Implication	Status	Condition	Reference
<i>Proved, unconditional</i>			
$BC \Rightarrow TPC$	Proved	—	Thm 7.5
$BC \Rightarrow GC$	Proved	—	Thm 6.4
$WDC \Rightarrow GC$	Proved	—	Thm 6.3
Channel Exhaustion $\Rightarrow (\mathcal{W} \text{ fin.} \Rightarrow \mathbb{P} \text{ fin.})$	Proved	—	Thm 11.3
$\mathbb{P} \text{ finite} \Rightarrow \perp$	Proved	—	Euclid
<i>Proved, conditional</i>			
$WDC + TPC \Rightarrow BC$	Proved	WDC, TPC	Thm 7.6
<i>Conjectured</i>			
$PNT \Rightarrow (WDC \wedge BC)$	Open	—	Conj 12.1
$GC \Rightarrow WDC$	Open	—	Conj 7.8
Channel Exhaustion	Open	—	Conj 11.1
WDC	Open	—	Conj 7.1
BC	Open	—	Conj 7.3
<i>Corollary (follows from either structural conjecture)</i>			
GC	Open	WDC or BC	Conj 6.1, Thms 6.3, 6.4

The main chain (right arrow proved; left arrow conjectured):

$$PNT \dashrightarrow WDC \wedge BC \longrightarrow TPC \longrightarrow \mathbb{P} \text{ infinite.}$$

The channel exhaustion route:

$$PNT \dashrightarrow \text{Ch. Exhaustion} \longrightarrow (\mathcal{W} \text{ fin.} \Rightarrow \mathbb{P} \text{ fin.}) \longrightarrow \mathcal{W} \text{ infinite.}$$

Metric shadow:

$$WDC \longrightarrow GC \longleftarrow BC, \quad GC \dashrightarrow WDC \text{ (open).}$$

Arrow conventions: solid $\longrightarrow$ = proved unconditionally; dashed $\dashrightarrow$ = conjectured; double $\Longleftrightarrow$ = proved equivalence under stated condition.

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